Key date
Assassination of President Sadat: 1981

and the West, as Nasser had done, he had sold out. The Arab states cut off all relations with Egypt and moved the headquarters of the Arab League from Cairo to Tunisia.

Furthermore, even among the Egyptians, there was a small minority, mainly Islamic activists, who turned against Sadat for making peace with the Zionist enemy and for his hostility to the Islamic Revolution in Iran (see Chapter 7). In 1981, during a military parade in Cairo, Sadat was assassinated by a group of Islamic extremists within the army.

It was to be 15 years before another Arab state made peace with Israel. Meanwhile, at the heart of the conflict in the Middle East, there still remained the Palestinian problem. This is the subject of the next chapter.

Summary diagram: From war to peace: Yom Kippur to Camp David 1973–8

War of 'attrition' fought over Suez Canal between Israel and Egypt

Sadat went to war to break stalemate ('no peace, no war')

Yom Kippur War 1973

- Egypt and Syria surprise attack
- Israelis recover and go on offensive
- Arabs use oil weapon to pressure the West
- USA and Soviet Union force a ceasefire

Results of War

- Arabs regain pride and respect
- US 'shuttle diplomacy' leads to Israeli military withdrawals

Camp David 1978

- Sadat flew to Israel, thus recognising Israel
- Begin flew to Cairo
- USA brokered peace deal:
  - Israelis to withdraw from Sinai
  - Egypt to allow Israeli ships through Suez and Straits of Tiran